

CMSC701 Spring 2026: Wrap-up and FAQ

End of Semester FAQ

1. When is the final?
 - Take-home. Released May 11, due May 13. (On grade scope)
2. What content will be on the final?
 - The final is comprehensive, it will cover content from throughout the semester. We covered much more material than can be put on the final, so content will be selective (*in general, likelihood a topic will appear is proportional to time we spent on it*).
3. What will the format of the exam be?
 - Short answer / fill-in-the-blank & longer-form “thinking” and algorithm design questions
5. How can I prepare for the final?
 - Go over the lectures, go over your projects, google about material you still don’t get.
6. What resources can I use for the final
 - Anything on the class website, gradescope, or piazza.
 - You may *not* use AI on the final, or refer to other web resources.
7. Course survey. (<https://umd.bluera.com/umd/>)

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8. Final course project (gradescope).

- Due May 18 (11:59PM).
- No extensions possible, no late penalty, submission will close at 11:59PM on the 18
- Deliverables:
 - Report (~ 5 page, research style document)
 - I recommend (do not require) the OUP template (<https://www.overleaf.com/latex/templates/oup-general-template/ybpypwncdxyb>)
 - Any associated code (in a GitHub repository)
- NOTES: You should write the report yourself (no AI authors).

9. Other questions?

What we didn't cover.

Most of bioinformatics and computational biology:

- much of “long read” technology and method development
- non-RNA single-cell genomics (e.g. single-cell ATAC-seq, CRISPR)
- metagenomics
- biological network analysis
- “systems” biology (e.g. regulatory inference)
- biostatistics and statistical interpretation of genomics results
- modern approaches of machine learning in bioinformatics (deep learning)
- much, much more.
- If you like this content consider taking CMSC702 with Prof. Erin Molloy in the Fall.
- If you'd like to explore these ideas further (& build new ones), consider setting up a meeting to chat about my lab (or doing a research project with us)!